Octavian Vacarciuc

Senior Backend Engineer (PHP, Laravel)

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Romanian (EU) citizen, authorized to work in the EU without visa sponsorship

SUMMARY

Senior Backend Engineer with **12 years of experience** in PHP and Laravel, building microservices and REST APIs for SaaS, logistics, e-commerce and telecom. Strong in MySQL, PostgreSQL, Elasticsearch, Redis, RabbitMQ, Docker, Kubernetes and AWS/GCP. Led backend teams of up to 5 and optimized databases processing **up to 1B rows per day**.

EXPERIENCE

Backend Laravel Developer
01/2025 – 09/2026

Route4Me | Remote
SaaS route optimization platform, 150+ employees worldwide

- Worked within an **8-person backend team** building and maintaining microservices and internal libraries for a high-scale route optimization SaaS product.
- Designed and shipped a **universal query builder library** — a driver-agnostic abstraction layer with 2 built-in drivers (MySQL, Elasticsearch) and support for custom drivers via a unified interface, adopted across the team as a core internal tool.
- Built and maintained **REST APIs and microservices** on top of 4 data stores: Elasticsearch full-text search, Redis caching, Google Cloud Datastore, and Google Spanner for distributed relational workloads.
- Covered new features with **automated PHPUnit tests** following TDD and containerized services in Docker, ensuring consistent environments across dev and production deployments.

Stack: PHP 8.x, Laravel, MySQL, PostgreSQL, Elasticsearch, Redis, Google Cloud Datastore, Google Spanner, RabbitMQ, Docker, Kubernetes, GCP, GitHub Actions, PHPUnit

PHP Team Lead & Backend Engineer
03/2021 – 11/2024

WebRocks | Chisinau, Moldova
Outsourcing company, HQ in the Netherlands

- Led a backend team of 5, running weekly planning and retrospectives that reduced sprint blockers by ~50% through proactive coordination of cross-team dependencies.
- Architected and delivered core features for an **academic SaaS platform** — appointment scheduling, internal messaging, class timetables, and task tracking — used by 1,000+ end users.
- Upgraded a **Dutch salon-chain CRM** with cashier-specific workflows (shift management, payment flows), cutting average transaction processing steps by 40%.
- Refactored an e-commerce platform codebase, improving response times by ~30% and enabling safe parallel feature development through standardized code review processes.

Stack: PHP, Laravel, Vue.js, Node.js, MySQL, PostgreSQL, Redis, Memcached, RabbitMQ, Docker, AWS, GitHub Actions, WebSockets, PHPUnit, Sentry

Senior Full-Stack Engineer
06/2019 – 02/2021

WorkIT / Dispatch42 | Chisinau, Moldova
Logistics technology

- Built a **real-time route calculation engine** for freight dispatchers — computing optimal routes and toll costs across multiple jurisdictions with geo-mapping integration.
- Developed document management and in-app chat systems supporting high-throughput dispatcher workflows and critical shipment record-keeping.
- Delivered web service infrastructure handling concurrent dispatcher sessions with low-latency data retrieval.

Stack: PHP, Laravel, Vue.js, Node.js, MySQL, Redis, RabbitMQ, Docker, AWS, WebSockets

Senior Software Engineer
10/2017 – 05/2019

Ideaction.io | Chisinau, Moldova
Outsourcing company, US and UK clients

- Delivered **3+ startup MVPs** from zero to production in under 6 months each, working directly with US and UK product owners in an async-first environment.

- Implemented real-time **1:1 and group chat** over WebSockets and WebRTC-based **video calling** across multiple products.
- Integrated AWS stack (EC2, S3, API Gateway, Lambda) for serverless-ready, cost-efficient backend architecture.
- Built an **AR indoor navigation system** using Bluetooth beacon triangulation — a novel UX feature that became a key product differentiator.
- Managed and mentored 2 mid-level mobile developers (Android/iOS), aligning engineering work with product roadmap milestones.

Stack: PHP, Laravel, Vue.js, Node.js, Python, MySQL, PostgreSQL, Redis, RabbitMQ, Docker, Nginx, AWS (EC2, S3, Lambda, API Gateway), WebSockets, WebRTC

Mid-level PHP Developer
10/2016 – 09/2017

Unifun | Chisinau, Moldova

Telecom solutions, 75+ countries

- Optimized database query performance for tables processing **up to 1 billion rows per day** in a high-load telecom environment.
- Parsed and adapted mobile network traffic (tShark, Wireshark) to meet country-specific operator protocols across 10+ markets.
- Provided 24/7 on-call incident response, remotely resolving system overloads and briefing monitoring teams under SLA pressure.

Stack: PHP, Go, MySQL, PostgreSQL, Redis, Memcached, RabbitMQ, Linux, Bash, tShark, Wireshark

Junior Software Engineer
06/2015 – 09/2016

Titanium Software | Chisinau, Moldova

Stack: PHP, Laravel, JavaScript, MySQL

Junior Software Engineer
03/2014 – 05/2015

EBS Integrator | Chisinau, Moldova

Stack: PHP, Laravel, JavaScript, MySQL

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming Languages: PHP 8.x, Go, Python 3, JavaScript, Bash

Frameworks & Runtimes: Laravel, Eloquent ORM, Laravel Queues, Laravel Sanctum, Laravel Passport, Laravel Horizon, Laravel Telescope, Vue.js, Node.js

PHP Tooling & Testing: Composer, PSR, PHPStan, PHPUnit, Selenium

Databases & Search: MySQL, PostgreSQL, Redis, Elasticsearch, Memcached, Google Spanner, Google Cloud Datastore

Cloud: Google Cloud Platform (GCP), AWS (EC2, S3, Lambda, API Gateway)

Infrastructure & CI/CD: Docker, Kubernetes, Nginx, Linux, CI/CD, GitHub Actions, GitLab CI

Messaging & Real-Time: Kafka, RabbitMQ, WebSockets, WebRTC

APIs & Security: REST, OpenAPI/Swagger, OAuth2, JWT, Webhooks

Monitoring: Prometheus, Grafana, Sentry, ELK Stack

Architecture & Practices: Microservices, SOLID, DDD, Event-Driven Architecture, CQRS, TDD, Agile/Scrum, Code Review

AI Tools: Claude Code, Codex, OpenCode, Ollama, Local LLMs

Other Tools: Git, Jira, tShark, Wireshark

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Information Technology | UPSC, Chisinau | 2014 – 2017

College of Information Technology | CEITI, Chisinau | 2010 – 2014

LANGUAGES

Romanian (Native), Russian (C2), English (B2), Italian (A1)

INTERESTS

Travel, Fishing, BBQ, Cooking, 3D Printing